

Facilitator's Note & Printing Guide

Companion to the “Name the Story You Carry” Participant Worksheet

SESSION	FORMAT	WORKSHEET	AUDIENCE
60-Minute Impact	Breakout / Workshop	Section 5 · 9 pages	NAMIcon 2026 Attendees

Part One — Facilitator's Note

This worksheet is the reflective spine of the Unmuted impact session. It exists to help participants name a story they carry — privately, safely, and at their own pace. What follows is everything you need to run it with confidence: the purpose, the arc, the timing, the language, and the aftercare.

The worksheet is a reflection tool, not a disclosure tool. Treat it that way, and the room will follow.

Why This Worksheet Exists

Mental health stigma persists partly because people who have lived it are rarely given the structured, unhurried space to name their own experience before being asked to share it. The worksheet provides that space. Each prompt is deliberately sequenced to move a participant from lived experience (“the story you carry”) toward meaning-making (“what it taught you”), context (“identity + context”), audience (“who needs this”), and finally toward intentional impact (“what this story could shift”).

The closing Unmuted Narrative Framework (A–E) is offered as scaffolding for participants who want to shape their story for future sharing. It is not homework. It is a gift they may or may not open.

Core Facilitation Principles

1. Consent is the floor, not the ceiling.

Say out loud at the top of the session: no one will be asked to read aloud, no one will be asked to share specifics, and anything written on the worksheet belongs exclusively to the person holding the pen. Repeat this before each prompt transition if the room feels tense.

2. Silence is part of the work.

Reflection requires quiet. Resist the impulse to fill pauses with commentary. If a silence feels long, it is probably doing exactly what it should.

3. Honor the body in the room.

Some participants will be triggered by the prompts — this is normal and not a failure of facilitation. Name this possibility before starting. Remind participants that they can step out, skip any prompt, or stop entirely. Have the aftercare resources (below) posted or printed and visible.

4. Protect the threshold between private and public.

If you invite any sharing during the session, invite it at the level of insight (“What did the worksheet surface for you?”) rather than content (“What is your story?”). This protects privacy while still allowing the collective learning a session needs.

5. You are not a clinician in this room — you are a guide.

Even if you are clinically trained, the worksheet session is not a therapeutic intervention. If a participant discloses acute distress, your role is warm handoff to the aftercare resources and, if needed, to the NAMIcon on-site mental health support team.

Part Two — 60-Minute Run of Show

The schedule below is a suggested arc. Adjust to the room, but protect the two non-negotiables: the opening grounding (five full minutes, no less) and the closing reflection (five full minutes, no less). Compression happens in the middle, never at the edges.

Time	Segment	What Happens
0:00 – 0:05	Welcome + Land	Welcome participants. State the consent floor (no one shares unless they choose to). Introduce the worksheet as a private reflection tool. Hand out worksheets if not already distributed.
0:05 – 0:10	Grounding	Walk through Page 1 aloud. Lead the three-breath grounding (Breathe In · Settle · Breathe Out). Read the “How to Use This Worksheet” bullets. Set the tone: slow, quiet, unhurried.
0:10 – 0:18	Prompt 1	Read prompt aloud. Invite 6–7 minutes of silent writing on “The Story You Carry.” Do not circulate. Do not make eye contact — let people write without feeling watched.
0:18 – 0:25	Prompt 2	Brief transition (“When you’re ready, turn the page”). 6–7 minutes on “What This Story Taught You.”
0:25 – 0:32	Prompt 3	6–7 minutes on “Identity + Context.” This is often the most tender prompt. Offer: “Skip this one if it isn’t landing. You can return to it later.”
0:32 – 0:39	Prompt 4	6–7 minutes on “Who Needs This Story?” Energy often lifts here — the prompt turns outward.
0:39 – 0:46	Prompt 5	6–7 minutes on “The Impact of Your Story.” The pivot from private to possible.
0:46 – 0:52	Framework Walk-Through	Walk the room through Page 8 — the Unmuted Narrative Framework (A–E). Read each stage aloud. Frame it as optional scaffolding for when and if they decide to share.
0:52 – 0:57	Closing Reflection	Read Page 9 aloud. Deliberately. “You don’t have to tell your story today... But you deserve to honor it.” Let the last line land in silence: “Your story is not just personal — it is a catalyst.”
0:57 – 1:00	Aftercare + Close	Name the aftercare resources. Invite participants to take the worksheet with them, not leave it behind. Thank the room. Do not linger on Q&A — protect the tone you just built.

TIMING DISCIPLINE

If you run long on a prompt, cut from the middle (Prompts 3 or 4), never from the grounding or the closing. The closing is what carries participants out of the room safely.

Part Three — Language You Can Borrow

Use your own voice — but these lines are tested and work. Read them, adapt them, or say them verbatim.

Opening the session

SAMPLE OPENING

“Before we begin, a few things. This worksheet is a reflection tool, not a disclosure tool. Nothing you write is collected. Nothing you write is shared unless you choose to share it — with yourself first, anyone else second. You can skip any prompt. You can stop at any time. You can step out of the room without explanation. We’re going to move slowly on purpose.”

Transitioning between prompts

Keep transitions minimal. Participants are in a reflective state — too much talk pulls them out. Try: “When you’re ready, turn the page” or simply “Next prompt, on the next page.”

If someone becomes visibly distressed

QUIET CHECK-IN

Approach quietly, crouch to eye level if you can, and say softly: “Take whatever time you need. You can step out, and I can go with you if that would help. There’s no wrong way to do this.” Then give them space. Do not escalate unless they ask you to.

Closing the session

SAMPLE CLOSING

“Thank you for the trust you brought into this room. Take the worksheet with you — it’s yours. If something surfaced today that you want to talk through, the aftercare resources are posted at the door. Your story is not just personal. It is a catalyst.”

Part Four — Aftercare Resources

Have these posted visibly in the room and printed on a small handout at the door. Say them aloud at the close.

- **Call or text 988:** 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline
- **Dial 988, then press 1 — or text 838255:** Veterans Crisis Line
- **Text HOME to 741741:** Crisis Text Line

- **1-800-950-NAMI (6264) — available Mon–Fri, 10 a.m.–8 p.m. ET:** NAMI HelpLine
- **Confirm booth or room location with conference staff before your session:** NAMIcon 2026
On-Site Mental Health Support

A NOTE ON DISCLOSURE

If a participant discloses active suicidal ideation or immediate harm to themselves or another person during or after the session, your role is calm, warm handoff to on-site support or 988 — not to counsel them yourself. Stay with them until handoff is complete.

Part Five — Printing Guide

The worksheet was designed at full-bleed quality for professional print. These specifications will preserve the intended look whether you print at home, at a local shop, or through a conference print vendor.

File Specifications

File format	PDF (vector-preserved)
Trim size	8.5" × 11" (US Letter)
Orientation	Portrait
Page count	9 pages
Color mode	Full color (CMYK-compatible)
Bleed	Full-bleed on cover + closing pages; none required for interior
Resolution	Print-ready at 300 DPI equivalent
Fonts	Embedded (Cormorant Garamond, Inter)

Recommended Print Settings

For professional print vendors (FedEx Office, Staples, local shops)

1. Request color printing on 80 lb cream or off-white uncoated text-weight paper (this complements the cream background and reduces eye strain during reflection).
2. Ask for full-bleed on the cover and closing pages if the vendor supports it. If not, standard 8.5" × 11" will still look excellent — the white margin will simply frame the teal.
3. Binding: saddle-stitch (single staple on the fold) if printed as 11" × 17" folded, or simple corner-stapled if printed flat at 8.5" × 11".
4. For NAMIcon volume: request a proof copy before running the full order. Cream paper stock can vary in tone between vendors.

For in-house / at-home printing

1. Set printer to best or photo quality, not draft.
2. Select actual size (do not scale to fit) to preserve typography proportions.
3. Print both sides if your printer supports duplex. If not, print single-sided — the generous margins make it readable either way.

8. **4.** Use ivory, cream, or natural-white paper (24 lb or heavier). Avoid bright white — it fights the cream page background.

Paper & Binding Recommendations

Setting	Recommended	Why
Paper weight	80–100 lb text	<i>Heavy enough to feel substantial; light enough to fold cleanly.</i>
Paper color	Cream / natural white	<i>Matches the interior page color and reduces glare.</i>
Finish	Uncoated	<i>Takes pen ink cleanly — participants will be writing on it.</i>
Binding	Saddle-stitch or corner staple	<i>Keeps the worksheet intact without getting in the way of writing.</i>
Quantity buffer	+15% above attendee count	<i>Walk-ins, spills, and people who want a second copy for a loved one.</i>

Digital / Tablet Distribution

If NAMIcon 2026 offers a digital session track, the worksheet can also be distributed as a fillable PDF. A few considerations:

- Participants writing on tablets will benefit from a stylus. Suggest this in your pre-session email.
- The PDF as delivered is read-only. If a fillable version is needed, let me know and I can produce one with form fields on each writing space.
- Digital participants still benefit from the three-breath grounding — ask them to step away from screens for the first two minutes.

Part Six — Pre-Session Checklist

Run through this the day of your session. If any item is uncertain, resolve it before participants enter the room.

☐	Worksheets printed and counted (+15% buffer)
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☐	Aftercare resources printed, posted visibly, and confirmed accurate
☐	NAMICon on-site support location/contact confirmed
☐	Pens distributed — one per seat (ideally black or dark blue)
☐	Room set for reflection: chairs slightly spaced, lights softened if possible
☐	Water available at the back of the room (not passed during reflection)
☐	Timer set discreetly — visible to you, not to participants
☐	Opening, transition, and closing lines reviewed one final time
☐	Phone silenced. Your full attention is the room's most valuable resource
☐	Take one breath for yourself before you open the door

You are not performing a session. You are holding a space. The worksheet does the work; your job is to protect the room while it happens.

— *End of Facilitator Note* —

Unmuted · Storytelling as a Tool for Stigma Shattering & System Shifting